

Architecting the Future: How Priyanka Gera is Transforming Asia's Commercial Real Estate Landscape

In an industry notorious for its resistance to digital transformation, Priyanka Gera stands out as a visionary disruptor. The founder and CEO of Aeria is pioneering an AI-powered revolution in commercial real estate that promises to reshape how properties are managed across the Asia-Pacific region.

Asia's commercial real estate market spans an impressive 52 billion square feet and is growing at a robust CAGR of 15%. Yet this massive sector remains stubbornly anchored to outdated operational practices. It's precisely this disconnect that Gera identified as her entrepreneurial opportunity.

"We no longer see real estate as just a physical space—it's evolving into an experience," says Gera. "With Gen Z entering the workforce and companies focusing on employee engagement, technology must power these spaces to create seamless interactions."

This perspective comes from a rare combination of expertise. An architect from SPA-Delhi with finance specialization from IIM Calcutta, Gera's career trajectory provided her with unique insights into the industry's pain points and potential solutions.

Gera's journey began at real estate giant JLL, where she witnessed the company's remarkable growth from a ₹100 crore to ₹3,500 crore business in under a decade. This front-row seat to explosive industry growth sparked her entrepreneurial ambitions.

In 2017, she co-founded OxfordCaps, addressing gaps in the student housing segment. Within three years, she



Priyanka Gera
founder and CEO of Aeria

scaled it to a \$20 million ARR business before successfully exiting in 2021—a testament to her business acumen and execution capabilities.

With her second venture, Gera remains committed to proptech but with a more ambitious vision. Aeria's AI-enabled platform integrates over 100 technologies into a seamless ecosystem that transforms commercial real estate operations and asset management.

The platform digitizes and automates traditionally manual processes, offering comprehensive solutions including access control,

visitor management, parking optimization, tenant engagement, mobility solutions, and IoT-enabled facilities management.

This value proposition has already attracted significant investment attention. In March 2024, Aeria secured \$1.8 million in pre-seed funding led by Kalaari Capital and Fundamental VC, validating Gera's vision for the sector.

Aeria has quickly gained traction among leading developers and corporate occupiers across Asia. By creating a bridge between property owners and occupants, the platform is establishing new benchmarks for commercial real estate efficiency and user experience.

Industry analysts project that proptech investments will increase at a CAGR of 15%, reaching \$16 billion by 2030, with commercial and industrial sectors emerging as the most lucrative segments. Gera's Aeria is perfectly positioned to capitalize on this growth trajectory.

Gera's impact extends beyond her entrepreneurial ventures. She co-hosts the upcoming podcast "2 Unbroker Girls," designed to empower Indian consumers with insights for informed real estate decisions. Through expert analysis and candid discussions, she aims to demystify the complexities of property transactions.

A recognized champion for women in entrepreneurship, Gera's achievements have earned her prestigious recognitions including the BW Woman Entrepreneur Award (2020), a place in Forbes India's Gamechangers, and Singapore Business Review's 50 Rising Women in Tech in SE Asia (2020).

As Asia's real estate sector continues its technological evolution, Priyanka Gera's innovative approach with Aeria represents not just a business success story, but a fundamental reimagining of how built environments can better serve their occupants in the digital age.